

AML/CFT Public Statement

Immigration Consulting Services

This statement explains why Bird & Yang may ask clients to provide identity, authority, immigration, relationship, employment, business, financial, and payment information before or during immigration consulting services.

Why we may ask for information

Immigration consulting is not normally an AML/CFT (the Anti-Money Laundering and Countering Financing of Terrorism) reporting service by itself. However, we may ask for identification, authority, funds, relationship, employment, business, and other information for client acceptance, fraud prevention, immigration evidence, payment processing, privacy, and professional compliance.

If your immigration matter is connected with legal, accounting, business, investment, property, or other services, further AML/CFT checks may apply through the relevant Bird & Yang division.

Information we may request

Depending on the visa or service, we may ask for passports, identity documents, proof of address, relationship evidence, employment documents, education records, business documents, tax or financial information, bank statements, source of funds documents, police certificates, medical evidence, and authority for persons instructing us or assisting with the application.

For employer, business, investor, partnership, trust, or company-related matters, we may ask for information about ownership, control, authorised representatives, directors, shareholders, trustees, beneficiaries, source of funds, and the purpose of the arrangement.

Source of funds and immigration evidence

Some immigration categories require evidence of available funds, income, business ownership, investment funds, maintenance funds, sponsorship, or lawful source of funds. We may ask for documents that help explain where funds came from and whether they can be relied on for immigration purposes.

Supporting documents may include bank statements, employment income records, business financial records, tax records, property sale documents,

investment records, inheritance evidence, loan documents, gift declarations, or accountant or solicitor confirmations.

When information must be provided

We may be unable to assess a pathway, prepare an application, lodge documents, communicate with Immigration New Zealand, or continue acting until required information has been provided and checked. Incomplete or inconsistent information may cause delay, refusal risk, or requests for further information.

How we protect information

We treat immigration, identity, financial, employment, relationship, health, and character information confidentially and securely. Information may be used or disclosed only for the agreed services, related administration, professional compliance, or where authorized, required, or permitted by law.

Our approach

We take a practical, risk-based approach to client verification and document review. We may ask follow-up questions, request further evidence, update information, or refer a matter to legal, accounting, or other advisers where required.

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